

PR Summary: Harden Codexa Model Guidance

Branch: `codex/general/codexa-019fa0eb-model-guidance`

Base: `main` at `c7bd6943cc23e2fba1339cb54669179d4744e1bb`

Release candidate: **0.17.1** (patch)

Outcome

Codexa now gives models a clearer route from repository orientation to bounded changes. It distinguishes exploration from edit authority, guides targetless work through search and inspection, preserves evidence-backed next steps, and keeps post-edit review advisory unless blocking evidence requires otherwise.

Target-role boundaries are now authority-critical. If compact, detailed, fallback, or artifact delivery omits editable, read-only, or excluded roles, the result fails closed, removes executable follow-up guidance, and asks the model to narrow the target before acting. A safe detailed resource remains available when only the concise receipt is incomplete.

The retrieval classifier also preserves ordinary source-change intent: *change planning logic* is edit-directed, while list-style read-only phrases remain orientation-only.

Commits

- **a556887** - fix(mcp): harden model guidance
- **1971e16** - fix(mcp): fail closed on truncated target roles
- **49bf059** - fix(retrieval): preserve planning logic edit requests

Risk-Budgeted Review

- Closed role loss across generic, typed, deep, array, summary, fallback, and transport-limited projections.
- Closed unsafe artifact persistence, stale visible authority text, and leaked nextCall authority in raw, kernel, and envelope lifecycle paths.
- Separated harmless shared-object aliases from true cycles; cycles and exhausted traversal budgets remain fail-closed.
- Corrected the planning-logic prompt-routing regression. Final independent review found no remaining actionable blocker.

Validation

- `npm run check`: passed.
- `npm run eval:ci`: passed, 21 scenarios, score 1, `rawRgBetter=0`.
- Focused MCP, retrieval, envelope, artifact-equivalence, and core-profile suites: 268 tests passed.
- Live local core-profile MCP smoke: complete focus stayed `edit_ready` with bounded `change_plan`; role loss stayed blocked.

Delivery and Rollback

Delivery follows protected main: source PR, Release Please patch PR, GitHub Release v0.17.1, npm publication, MCP Registry publication, and live package smoke. If a post-merge issue is found, use a forward revert PR; do not force-push or rewrite release history.